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Timothy Jackson, AIDS Foundation Chicago senior director of policy and advocacy, is pushing for state lawmakers to increase HIV/AIDS funding this session. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

HIV advocates seek \$6.5M funding boost

Trump cuts threaten medication access for thousands of people

By Jack O'Connor
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — With cuts to HIV and AIDS programs looming from President Donald Trump's administration, advocates are pressing Illinois lawmakers to fill a growing void or face a situation for which they say the state is unprepared.

It's a "life or death situation," Timothy Jackson, senior director of policy and advocacy at AIDS Foundation Chicago, said of those living with HIV or AIDS and the possibility of losing access

to healthcare and medication.

"If you are a person living with HIV and you cannot secure your medications, it is going to progress to an AIDS diagnosis," said Jackson, who was diagnosed with HIV 17 years ago. "And people are going to die."

But with a tight state budget and many lawmakers reluctant to commit to new spending, advocates like Jackson realize it's an uphill battle. Still, groups like AIDS Foundation Chicago are calling for a \$6.5 million increase in the state's HIV "lump sum" — a collection of grants and programs dedicated to

HIV and AIDS testing, treatment, education and more — to minimize damage from federal funding cuts. The HIV lump sum of \$25.56 million has not been increased since the 2021 budget.

"I know the state budget is tight, I know circumstances are really rough, but I've seen them definitely go above and beyond to put in money when the budget was tight," said Aces Lira, director of public policy at Equality Illinois.

Gov. JB Pritzker's provisional budget, released in February,

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'BROADVIEW SIX' CASE

Aftershocks spread to a new case

Prosecutor accused of misconduct in grand jury and US attorney orders 'sweeping' reforms

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The aftershocks of the "Broadview Six" case collapse have now spread to another high-profile case, where lawyers for a Texas man accused of being a low-level participant in a massive COVID-19 testing scam with a former Loretto Hospital executive say the same federal prosecutor committed "flagrant and pervasive" misconduct in the grand jury.

In a filing Tuesday night, attorneys for Mahmood Sami Khan said the indictment against him should be thrown out due to the revelations of misconduct by the U.S. attorney's office, both in the grand jury — which was the same panel that ultimately returned an indictment in the Broadview case — and in a later attempt to cover up what had happened.

And in a parallel case involving fraud at Loretto Hospital, prosecutors have said they are turning over new material to the defense that could scuttle planned guilty pleas by two former hospital officials, court records show.

The widening controversy



U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros at a Dirksen U.S. Courthouse interview on April 3. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

has also prompted U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros to order "sweeping" internal reforms to the office's grand jury practices, including "deep-dive" training from outside national experts, his office said in a news release Wednesday.

The new measures, which took effect Tuesday, will "be more transparent, effective, and impactful while greatly reducing the likelihood of mistakes and errors," the news release stated.

The filing in Khan's case, meanwhile, alleged an unidentified assistant U.S. attorney — who has

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Johnson: Police better without ShotSpotter

Mayor points to study showing faster response times

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson argued Wednesday that Chicago police are doing a better job without gunshot detection technology like the controversial ShotSpotter system he got rid of, even as his administration is considering bids from other companies to take over installing such tools citywide.

Johnson pointed to a study from the Justice Project at the University of Chicago that determined response times where the technology operated have improved 4.2 minutes on average since he ended the ShotSpotter deal in September 2024. That's proof, the mayor argued, that critics' "consternation" about his decision was unfounded.

He panned "farmongering" around his move away from an "ineffective" technology that he

previously accused of slowing police down by overloading them with alerts.

"(To) those who were obviously promoting fear and casting doubt on our effort to improve safety, this is clear evidence that we are clearly moving in the right direction," he said.

The mayor, also grappling with thorny public safety questions tied to several large youth gatherings that ended in violence over the Memorial Day weekend, did not directly answer questions about the status of the city's plans to purchase a new gunshot detection system when asked if the Justice Project analysis would lead him to halt that process.

"I've never been opposed to technology, I've only been opposed to technology that is proven to be ineffective," Johnson said.

The study compared average response times to the most serious 911 calls in the six months before the system was shut down

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Messages conflict on status of talks with Iran

The White House denies news report of a potential deal draft

By Aamer Madhani
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump asserted on Wednesday that Iran is "negotiating on fumes" and insisted that November's midterm elections won't make him rush into a deal to end the nearly 3-month-old conflict that's spurred unease across the global economy.

Speaking at the start of a Cabinet meeting, Trump expressed confidence that a deal is near. Over the weekend, he even declared that his administration and Tehran had "largely negotiated"

a settlement, though the talks are still in flux.

The president is looking for a settlement that will reopen the Strait of Hormuz and provide him with a credible argument that Iran's nuclear capability has been diminished enough to declare victory, winding down a conflict that's been politically unpopular for Republicans.

But as things stand, Trump also risks finding that closure to his war of choice comes with an unsatisfactory ending.

The emerging deal puts off many critical issues to be resolved later and has already exposed the Republican president to fierce criticism — even from some of his own supporters — that Iran's

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President Donald Trump speaks during a Cabinet meeting at the White House on Wednesday. **WIN MCNAMEE/GETTY**

INSIDE

Another losing streak? Been there, done that



As bad as the Cubs have been since their 20-3 stretch led into a 2-14 slump, the fact they went 2-13 in the first place indicates the talent is in place for a potential rebound, writes Paul Sullivan. **Sports**

Johnson and allies travel to meet pope

The Chicago delegation traveling with Mayor Brandon Johnson to meet Pope Leo XIV includes some of his closest allies, as well as business owners looking to get closer to both leaders this week. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

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